



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 8

CASE STUDY - 8

The chairperson of the state Child Rights' Protection Commission visited a government aided school for a surprise inspection. The school is known for its achievements in learning outcomes, and thus is favoured by many economically weaker parents of the locality for quality education for their wards. Due to the overwhelming applications for admissions, the school management is flexible in admitting as many students as it can so that the poor students stand a better chance of succeeding in their academics by receiving good education.

However, the chairperson was dismayed to find the following dismal scenario:

- a) Absence of safety norms and lack of cleanliness in the four-storeyed building housing LKG to 10th class, due to over crowding
- b) No clean drinking water, and the students are made to clean the water tank situated on top of the building, without which the water will be unpalatable
- c) Segregation of Dalits and non-Dalits during the midday meal, with Dalit students made to sit in the hot sun for lunch
- d) Only seven toilets for more than 900 students, forcing the students to relieve themselves in the open

As the official responsible to ensure the protection of child rights', what options do you have in dealing with the situation? Which option would you prefer and why? (250 words)

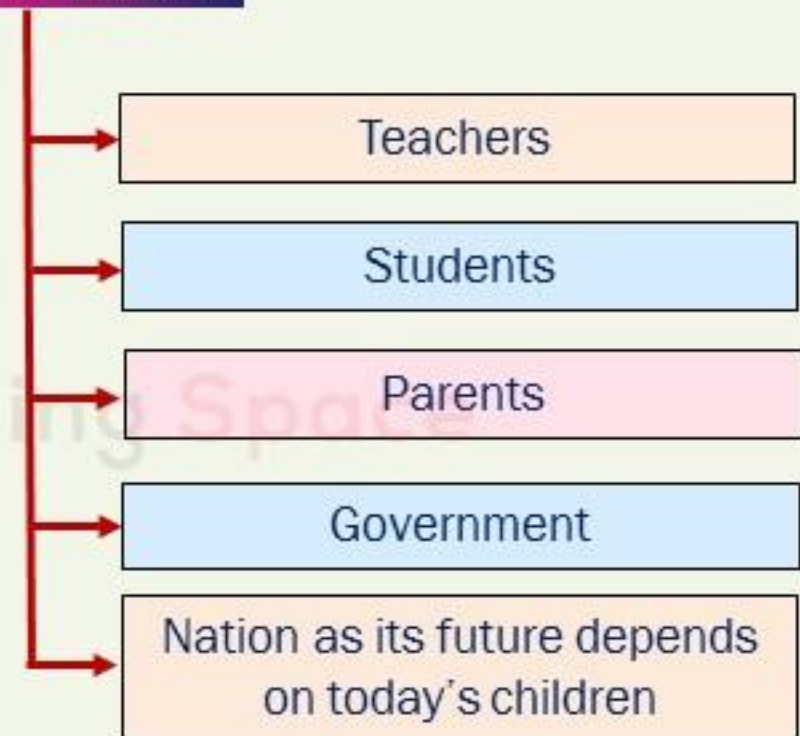
CASE STUDIES

The case reflects the poor state of affairs of Government schools in reality. This results in education dropouts, mostly the female students.

ETHICAL ISSUES INVOLVED

- Affordability of education vs. Health, Nutrition and safety of children
- Access to education vs. Reinforcing social inequalities
- Child education vs. child labour
- Better learning outcomes vs. better values towards health and life

STAKEHOLDERS



CASE STUDIES

As a Child Rights' Panel Chief, I have the following options

OPTION 1

Appreciate the learning outcomes and neglect other problems as the learning outcomes matter the most.

MERITS

- Children from lower sections get quality learning outcomes.
- More children get affordable education

DEMERITS

- Children are vulnerable to stunting and under nutrition.
- Collapse of building may cost children's lives
- Reinforced inequalities are carried by children for lifetime
- Against child labour act.

OPTION 2

Send a report immediately about the situation and recommend closure of the school to District Magistrate

MERITS

- Children's lives are protected
- Prevents reinforcing social inequalities in the minds of children
- Punished for practicing child labour

DEMERITS

- Quality teaching and learning outcomes are affected
- Children may not join other schools
- No guarantee that children get nutritious food

CASE STUDIES

The option I prefer

OPTION 3

- Prepare a report on the findings and send to district magistrate immediately to regularly monitor the school in future.
- Warn the teachers that any negligence or compromise on children's safety would not be tolerated.
- Talk to teachers for needs of funds and check the utilisation of Government funds till then.
- Send a report for need of funds to the concerned ministry and district magistrate.
- Inform children that they are equal and any practice of discrimination should be immediately informed by providing them a contact number.
- Make children aware that cleaning is not their duty while in school.
- Appreciate teachers for quality teaching, but write remarks on their performance sheet regarding practice of inequalities.

CONCLUSION

Childhood is the stage of building strong value-based personalities. Schools should be a means to meet essential needs of quality education based on values, nutritious food and necessary life skills.

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SINCERE THANKS
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